

DAVID KARIUKI

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ELECTRICAL & COMPUTER ENGINEERING / SOFTWARE / AI SYSTEMS

PROFILE

Final-year Electrical and Computer Engineering student and founder of Common Compute. I have built political messaging systems, student tools and software for human-agent work. I am strongest when a problem is still unclear: I turn it into requirements, build the system, test it and stay accountable for what happens after release.

EDUCATION

University of Cape Town

Feb 2022 to Dec 2026

BSc(Eng), Electrical and Computer Engineering

Final-year research: designing a digital reference verification tool that retrieves scholarly records, compares fields, communicates uncertainty and preserves the evidence behind each proposed correction.

EXPERIENCE AND LEADERSHIP

Founder, Common Compute

Jan 2025 to present

Build AI products including Granular, Kerra and Relay. Work across product decisions, architecture, web and desktop software, data systems, testing and release infrastructure. PlanItUni acquired Kerra in a transaction worth approximately R320,000 after it reached students at more than 300 US universities within three weeks of launch.

Co-founder and Chairman, AI Society at UCT

May 2023 to Jan 2025

Co-founded and chaired a student AI community that grew to more than 600 members. Built the structure, purpose and shared ownership needed for a volunteer technical community to keep moving.

Co-founder, Intelli AI

Aug 2023 to Aug 2024

Built AI agents for political campaigning. The company earned about R3.6 million in revenue and sent 7 million messages for parliamentary political parties and a major PAC. The work made risk communication, visible assumptions and post-release monitoring central to my engineering practice.

Co-founder, Gather AI Social Assistant

Jun 2024 to Jan 2025

Built and shipped an AI social application, taking the product from an open-ended idea to software released for real users.

SELECTED ENGINEERING WORK

Reference verification prototype

Research, 2026

Crossref-backed interface with candidate metadata, field warnings, an evidence trace and export. Current work focuses on multi-field scoring, calibration and established CSL citation rendering.

Granular

Product engineering, 2026

Evidence system that keeps source documents, spreadsheet cells and agent actions beside the claims they support. Website: granular.work

Relay

Human-agent systems, 2026

Communication layer that separates the short message a person needs from the detailed context their AI agent needs, while preserving intent and privacy boundaries.

CAPABILITIES

Engineering	Software	Professional practice
Systems thinking Requirements and trade-offs Evidence-led validation Technical research	TypeScript / React Node.js / Python Web and desktop systems Git / CI / Cloudflare	Technical writing Team implementation Risk communication Ethical reflection